

Commission yet to agree on key details of ETS review

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By Ben Makuch · Jul 16, 2026, 12:50 PM · [View in your browser](#)

The European Commission is yet to agree on key details of its revision of the EU Emissions Trading System just a day before it is set to be released, due to objections from senior Commission officials.

Executive vice-presidents Stéphane Séjourné and Raffaele Fitto, and EU transport chief Apostolos Tzitzikostas have signaled they have reservations about the proposal, according to two EU officials confirmed to POLITICO, with discussions continuing into Thursday.

The EU executive has also pushed back its technical briefing for journalists from Thursday to early Friday morning. Normally such briefings happen the day before the release of new legislation.

Multiple people familiar with the negotiations described a week of internal fights between high ranking officials and disagreements over major aspects of EU climate chief Wopke Hoekstra's draft proposal.

Sticking points include how the Commission intends to introduce international carbon credits into the ETS regime and how low the linear reduction factor — the rate at which pollution emissions are lowered annually — will be decreased.

Two members of the center-right European People's Party — the party of both Commission President Ursula van der Leyen and Hoekstra — have described a "very touchy" situation at the Commission.

Exact figures governing major policy points inside the ETS review, for example, have not yet been certified. "[They] are negotiating now on the top level," said one EPP member who had heard about the progress of negotiations within the Commission, "and the key parameters are to be decided only Friday morning just before presentation by [van der Leyen] herself (or her close circle)."

Zia Weise and Gabriel Gavin contributed reporting.

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